

4.1.3 VoIP

Voice over IP, also called Internet Telephony, is the routing of voice conversations over the Internet or any IP (Internet Protocol) network. VoIP can be used on any network connection, including ones



Voice over IP is being touted as the new revolution in telephony

that do not have an Internet connection. VoIP has a number of advantages and it is widely believed that this will replace the PSTN (Public Switched Telephone Network)—present telecom protocols.

Using VoIP, one can send and receive data files and messages and have a conversation at the same time. VoIP also supports conference facilities. However, the biggest advantage that VoIP has is the low calling cost and its ability to work on your existing hardware setup. Also, the functionality is based on a software (protocol), so constant upgrading of your system is not essential.

But will VoIP be the next big killer app of the networked world? Not until a few niggling issues are ironed out. VoIP-based commu-